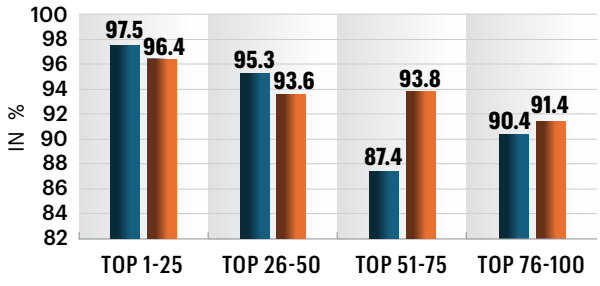


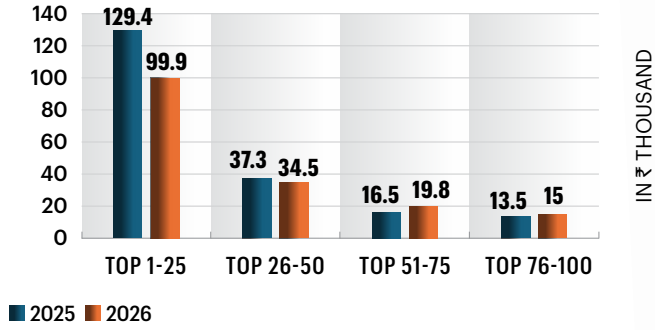
PREMIUM PLACEMENT

• Top 25 continues to maintain the highest placement rate, but with a marginal decline



AVERAGE STIPEND

• The Top 1–25 segment commands a substantial stipend premium, but average stipend declined sharply



SOURCE *BT*-MDRA BEST B-SCHOOLS SURVEY 2026-27

domain-led positions in strategy consulting, global capability centres, supply chain, banking and finance, and sales and marketing.

Debashis Chatterjee, Director of IIM Kozhikode, says internships have become "one of the most effective pathways to full-time hiring" because they give organisations an extended, real-world view of a candidate, including cultural fit and the ability to work within teams.

Saravanan Balasundaram, Founder & Group CEO of Bengaluru-based technology and talent consulting firm Han Digital Group, estimates internship-to-PPO conversion at 70–80%, with companies increasingly using internships as an extended assessment of live project delivery, client exposure, problem-solving, and cross-functional collaboration.

"Employers are increasingly reluctant to make a two-year bet on a CV and a few interview rounds. They want to see candidates work before committing to them," says Balasundaram.

Notably, some sectors continue to recruit during final placements, while others such as FMCG companies, parts of BFSI, and niche finance firms often prefer to see student interns in action before a hiring call, says Mandar Desai, Head of Professional Development & Placement at K J Somaiya Institute of Management in Mumbai.

According to Desai, the school has seen companies such as Goldman Sachs offer PPOs to students, with 100% conversion in the cases cited.

As companies become more selective, this is also creating a feedback loop: leading schools continue to attract the deepest recruiter relationships and the strongest candidates, while lower-tier institutions face greater pressure to differentiate themselves through specific capabilities, local industry links or specialised programmes.

That selectivity is also reshaping the campus market. More